

Advanced Research Announcement (ARA) with Calls Overview Information

NAICS Code: The NAICS Code for this acquisition is 541715 and the small business size is 1,000 employees.

Federal Agency Name: Air Force Research Laboratory (AFRL), Sensors Directorate, AFRL/RYW

ARA Title: Multi-Spectrum Defensive Electronic Warfare (MSDEW)

ARA Type: Initial Announcement

ARA Number: FA8650-20-S-1119

THIS IS AN ADVANCED RESEARCH ANNOUNCEMENT (ARA) THAT WILL SOLICIT PROPOSALS THROUGH CALLS. THIS ANNOUNCEMENT POSTS THE BASIC ARA AND DOES NOT REQUEST SUBMITTALS AT THIS TIME. THE BASIC ARA WILL REMAIN OPEN FOR CALLS UNTIL 13 JULY 2027.

Calls (See Section IV for instructions):

Over the period of this ARA, calls may be issued to request proposals for specific area(s) of interest. Each call will contain specific requirements and pertinent information. Proposals submitted in response to the calls will be accepted as specified in the individual calls and evaluated in accordance with the Proposal Review Information (Section V1 and V2). Offerors should monitor the SAM website at www.sam.gov in the event this announcement is amended or calls are issued.

Proposal Due Date and Time: To be determined (TBD) on individual calls.

NOTE: Proposal receipt after the due date and time shall be governed by the provisions of RFO 52.215-1(c)(3).

Submission: Proposals must be submitted to the Contracting Points of Contact (POCs) identified in the individual call.

Annual Updates: It is noted, for ease of reference, that this ARA will be republished at yearly intervals with required updates.

Solicitation Request: Air Force Research Laboratory (AFRL), Sensors Directorate, Wright-Patterson Air Force Base *is not* soliciting proposals on the overarching effort described below. Individual calls, within scope of the ARA, will be issued that detail specific requirements. Unless otherwise stated in an individual call, all other requirements listed within this ARA are considered applicable.

Type of Contract/Instrument: The Air Force reserves the right to award contract(s) and/or Other Transaction(s) (OT) pursuant to 10 U.S.C. 4023 or 10 U.S.C. 4022,

based on the instrument deemed most appropriate. It is anticipated that contracts awarded under this ARA will generally be FAR based Cost-Reimbursement, Indefinite Delivery/Indefinite Quantity (IDIQ), Multiple Award Fair Opportunity, and Other Transaction type awards. If the offeror chooses to propose an OT under the authority of 10 U.S.C. 4022, the offeror should ensure all applicable regulations are followed. Award type will be identified under each call.

NOTE: Cost reimbursable contracts require successful offerors to have an accounting system considered adequate by the Defense Contract Management Agency (DCMA) for tracking and costs applicable to the contract.

NOTE: If proposing a Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) based contract, the FAR clause references in this ARA shall apply. This announcement incorporates FAR and supplement provisions and clauses by reference. The full text of these provisions and clauses can be found at <https://www.acquisition.gov/>. If proposing an Other Transaction (OT) these FAR references and clauses would not apply. The terms and conditions of an OT will be developed and negotiated on a case-by-case basis.

Estimated Program Cost: The total estimated program value is \$396,600,000.00 with multiple awards ranging from \$20,000,000.00 to \$100,000,000.00 (the AF reserves the right to exceed amounts if determined to be in the best interest of the Government).

Anticipated Number of Awards: The Air Force anticipates awarding multiple awards for this announcement. However, the Air Force reserves the right to award zero, one, or more Other Transactions and/or contracts, for all, some or none of the solicited effort based on the offeror's ability to perform desired work and funding fluctuations. There is no limit on the number of OTs or contracts that may be awarded to an individual offeror.

Brief Program Summary: MSDEW will develop sensors and systems supplies to meet the need for the national defense for improved joint lethality in contested environments, the ability to strike diverse targets inside adversary air and missile defense networks, and support a force which can deploy, survive, operate, maneuver, and regenerate in all domains while under attack. The program advances the Air Force EW (signal) capabilities to meet the need for the national defense and requires acquisition of aeronautical supplies, parts, accessories and designs for experimental and test purposes. These above strategic objectives will be accomplished through design, modeling, simulation and analysis (MS&A), experimentation, testing, and demonstration of multi-spectrum threat warning and countermeasures sensors, systems and technologies.

Communication Between Prospective Offerors and Government

Representatives: Dialogue between prospective offerors and Government representatives is encouraged until submission of proposals. Technical communication will be managed by the technical POC listed below. Discussions with any of the POCs shall not constitute a commitment by the Government to subsequently fund or award any proposed effort. No guidance related to technical approach will be given. However,

questions related to the objectives of the effort or prior similar efforts may be answered. Only Contracting Officers are legally authorized to commit the Government. If there is any doubt as to whether a response provides a competitive advantage, the answer will be posted publicly via an amendment to this ARA on SAM.gov.

Address technical questions to the Technical POCs:

Robert DeSonia, Program Manager, AFRL/RWW (Primary)
2241 Avionics Circle, WPAFB OH 45433
(937) 656-8426 or robert.desonia@us.af.mil

Gary (Mike) Butcher, Technical Lead, AFRL/RWW (Alternate)
2241 Avionics Circle, WPAFB OH 45433
(937) 656-8425 or gary.butcher@us.af.mil

Address contracting questions to the Contracting POCs:

Kathryn Skaleski, Contract Specialist, AFRL/RKSW
2130 Eighth Street, Bldg. 45, WPAFB, OH 45433
kathryn.skaleski@us.af.mil

Richard Bailey II, Contracting Officer, AFRL/RKSW
2130 Eighth Street, Bldg. 45, WPAFB, OH 45433
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Full Text Announcement

- I. **Program Description:** Air Force Research Laboratory, Sensors Directorate (AFRL/RV) is announcing its intent to solicit proposals under this "ARA with Calls". Solicitations for proposals will be accomplished via calls. The calls will encompass the following effort:

1. **Statement of Objective/Description of Technical Area(s):**

The MSDEW Program will leverage government, industrial and commercial developed signal sensor technologies for the purpose of conducting integral experiments and testing that combine multiple signal sensor research areas across multiple portions of the electro-magnetic spectrum (including radio-frequency and electro-optical) and multiple domains (including air, space and cyber). The program will develop sensors and systems supplies to meet the need for the national defense for improved joint lethality in contested environments, the ability to strike diverse targets inside adversary air and missile defense networks, and support a force which can deploy, survive, operate, maneuver, and regenerate in all domains while under attack. The program advances the Air Force electronic warfare capabilities to meet the need for the national defense and requires acquisition of aeronautical supplies, parts, accessories, and designs for experimental and test purposes. These above strategic objectives will be accomplished through design, modeling, simulation & analysis (MS&A), experimentation, testing and demonstration of multi-spectrum threat warning and countermeasures sensors, systems and technologies.

MSDEW focuses on increasing our nation's overall battlespace awareness, platform protection capabilities and maintaining Air Superiority in contested environments through research and experimentation. The program will support the national security strategy by developing new operational concepts and capabilities to win without assured dominance in air, maritime, land, space and cyberspace domains.

Specific objectives include:

- Integrate multiple combinations of advanced signal sensors, processing, and exploitation capabilities focused on electronic warfare (EW), threat warning and countermeasures onto various weapon systems.
- Demonstrate and assess integrated EW, threat warning and countermeasures signal sensor systems in operationally relevant environments, both through laboratory simulation and real-world flight and/or field testing.
- Research and refine integrated sensor systems architecture, including open architecture, adaptable interfaces, and system component technologies to determine the optimal architecture for systems of sensor systems.
- Develop optimized processing for sensor systems and algorithms.

- Develop and assess both software and hardware interfaces for sensor systems and find new ways to integrate internal and external to aircraft using podded and non-traditional solutions.
- Research and perform experiments on integration methodologies involved with systems of sensor systems technologies to garner a better understanding on best practices and evaluation of performance profiles of combined sensor technologies.
- Transition effective EW techniques, systems and countermeasures for current and future threats including those utilizing multi-spectrum sensor fusion.

Calls to be issued against the MSDEW ARA must a) fall under at least one of the Technical Areas of Interest detailed in paragraph I.1.a. below, and b) involve at least one of the types of tasks detailed in paragraph I.1.b. below.

a. Technical Areas of Interest:

- 1) **Electro-Optic & Multi-Spectrum Countermeasures (EO/MS CM):**
Focuses on the development of threat knowledge, threat assessment and real-time threat detection through signal sensing and tracking technology for CM-response engagements. Design improved EO/MS CM response technologies and techniques including expendables, directed laser, and effectiveness assessments to support future Air Force requirements to include aircraft protection, "find, fix, track, target, engage and assess" (F2T2EA) efforts and "Advanced Battle Management System" (ABMS) requirements. Model, simulate and analyze to facilitate the above. Enhance testing and evaluation techniques to support systems engineering design for developmental testing and facilitation of transition to operational use.
- 2) **Counter-Directed Energy Weapon Threat Warning Sensors:**
Focuses on design and development of laser warning, resiliency system integration, multi-spectrum threat simulation, multiple threat simulation, as well as enhanced testing and evaluation techniques to support systems engineering design for developmental and experimental testing purposes.
- 3) **Counter-Missile Threat Warning Sensors:**
Focuses on design, development and demonstration of prototype advanced integrated missile warning systems while also advancing electro-optic test and developmental risk reduction methodologies to supplement procurement agency milestone achievements. Develop and integrate test protocols and instrumentation augmenting agency developmental testing goals in the areas of missile warning, hostile fire, combat identification, and wide area surveillance sensors. Integrate EO threat warning system prototypes with a federated EW bus technology.

4) **Cyber Secure, Trusted, and open EW Systems:**

Focuses on the design and development of EW systems that are cyber secure and trusted with emphasis on open systems to improve ease of integration of multiple sensor systems. These developments include both software and hardware solutions.

- b. **Tasks:** Various methods will be used to integrate EW technologies into systems of systems. Systems of signal sensors systems will also undergo testing and demonstration through multiple methods and domains. Creation of new and improved integration methods and technologies will also be conducted. Individual calls under this solicitation may include some or all of the following activities and may tailor requirements as appropriate.

1) **Integrating:**

The contractor shall integrate signal sensor technologies within technical areas of interest defined in paragraph I.1.a using various integration methods and tools. Supporting technologies, tools, techniques and methods required may be provided by the Government or designed by the contractor and will vary by call. The contractor shall procure and/or develop the software as required per call. Specific topics and requirements will vary by call.

2) **Testing and Demonstrating:**

The contractor shall capture technology/test requirements for laboratory and ground demonstrations, tests, or exercises. The contractor shall identify test platforms and environments applicable to test objectives. The contractor shall draft and coordinate documents for each test, e.g., Federal Aviation Regulation (FAR), test cards, and checklists. The contractor shall participate in periodic coordination meetings such as Configuration Control Board (CCB), Test Planning Working Group (TPWG), Safety Readiness Board (SRB), and Test Readiness Board (TRB) as well as perform relevant actions as required. The contractor shall coordinate with any and all pertinent stakeholders and partners at the Government's direction. The contractor shall document test reports.

3) **Participating in Flight and/or Field Tests:**

The contractor shall coordinate flight and/or field operations and specific test approvals with proper officials. The contractor shall capture technology/test requirements for real-world demonstrations, tests, or exercises. The contractor shall identify test platforms. The contractor shall draft and coordinate documents for each test (FAR, test cards, checklists). The contractor shall participate in periodic meetings (e.g., CCB, TPWG, SRB, & TRB) and perform relevant actions as required. The contractor shall procure materials to collect, store, and retrieve sensory data and any required air/ground truth data.

For flight tests, the contractor shall secure airworthiness and coordinate test ranges and collection targets. The contractor shall supply airworthy

aircraft and shall coordinate airspace, flight plans, permits, and frequency clearance with respective authorities. The contractor shall determine equipment configuration, setup, interconnections, and protocols, and integrate the system under test into a System Integration Laboratory and/or aircraft. The contractor shall hold Test Readiness Reviews (TRRs) and Flight Readiness Reviews (FRRs) as required. The contractor shall perform ground and flight activities to include aircraft preflight checks, sensor initialization and checks, instrumentation checks, and aircraft launch and recovery. The contractor shall execute all steps described in test cards and checklists.

4) Researching Sensor Integration Technologies:

The contractor shall conduct research, design and experimentation into new and/or improved integration methods and technologies. This task includes the design and refinement of integrated sensor systems architectures, including open architectures, adaptable interfaces, and system component technologies to determine the optimal architecture for systems of sensor systems. Potential areas for interest include Models-Based Systems Engineering, Digital Thread, and other automated integration tools. Specific topics and design requirements will vary by call.

5) Developing Software:

The contractor shall develop software as required by call. Software development may include (but is not limited to) software of image & signal processing algorithms, software interfaces, data processing, modeling and simulation.

6) Maturing and Transitioning:

Perform system maturation and transition activities to include:

- (O&M) developing software updates and maintenance for integration into operational systems. Provide modeling and simulation tools, and database updates.
- (Procurement) developing transition plans, performing and executing assessments, data collections, and/or modeling and simulation activities for application of technology to production unit/systems(s).
- (Other) participating in system deployment, technical troubleshooting, upgrading required equipment, training, and creating technological inputs, as needed.

2. Within Scope Modifications:

Potential offerors are advised that due to the inherent uncertainty of research and development efforts, awards resulting from this announcement may be modified during performance to make within scope changes, to include but not limited to, modifications that may increase overall contract ceiling amount.

3. **Deliverable Items:**

- a. Data Items: DD Form 1423-1 CDRLs will be utilized on contract awards. Applicable data items will be identified in each call. OTs will specify data items on a case-by-case basis.
- b. Software: Software deliverables are TBD per individual call, if applicable, and may include design and prototype procurement.
- c. Hardware: Hardware deliverables are TBD per individual call, if applicable, and may include design and prototype procurement.
- d. Other: TBD per individual call, if applicable.

4. **Schedule:**

- a. Overall Period of Performance: TBD per individual call.
- b. Data Items: TBD per individual call.
- c. Software: TBD per individual call.
- d. Hardware: TBD per individual call.

5. **Other Requirements:**

- a. **Program Security Classification:** It is anticipated that the majority of the awards will require Top Secret classification/safeguarding capability, but security classification will be determined for each award. A draft DD254 will be attached to each call, as applicable. If a DD254 is applicable, offerors must verify their Cognizant Security Office information is current with Defense Security Service (DSS) at www.dss.mil.
- b. **OPSEC:** General Operations Security (OPSEC) procedures, policies and awareness are required in an effort to reduce program vulnerability from successful adversary collection and exploitation of critical information. OPSEC will be applied throughout the life cycle of the contract. The Critical Information List (CIL) and the RY OPSEC Plan will be provided upon request by AFRL/RYOY Information Protection Office. While working on the Government installation, OPSEC guidance and OPSEC training will be provided by AFRL/RYOY Information Protection Office. This training will ensure contractors are familiar with RY's CIL and RY's OPSEC Plan as it pertains to their contract. The contractor shall apply OPSEC in their management of their current program IAW AFI 10-701 Operations Security and WPAFB Supplement to AFI-10-701.

- c. Program Protection Plan (PPP):** All DoD contractors (including subcontractors) shall supplement their current security practices by requiring any personnel involved in executing this contract where critical program information (CPI) has been identified to protect the CPI to the standards articulated in the Program Protection Plan and in accordance with DoDI 5200.39. Upon contract award, all identified DoD contractors (including subcontractors) shall acknowledge and meet the requirements stated by the Program Manager for the protection of CPI. The DoD contractor must immediately notify the U.S. Government upon the discovery of any nonconformance with CPI protection.
- d. Export Control:** Information involved in this effort may be subject to Export Control (International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR) 22 CFR 120-131, or Export Administration Regulations (EAR) 15 CFR 710-774). If effort is subject to export control, then a Certified DD Form 2345, Militarily Critical Technical Data Agreement, will be required to be submitted with proposal.
- e. Export-Control Items:** As prescribed by R-DFARS 225.7901-4, R-DFARS 252.225-7048, "Export Controlled Item (Jun 2013)" is contained in this solicitation. This clause (or similar language) shall be contained in ALL resulting awards.
- f. Safety:** The Contractor shall comply with all Air Force, federal, state, and local safety and environmental regulations. An approved safety plan in accordance with AFI 91-202 AFRL Supplement 1 shall be obtained before any experiment can be conducted at Wright-Patterson AFB and shall comply with all Air Force safety and environmental regulations. The contractor shall comply with system safety requirements contained in MIL-STD 882E, section 4, "General Requirements" for any deliverable systems or hardware and software interfaces with those components. The Contractor shall test and verify the safety-critical hardware and software for safety acceptance.
- g. Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System (CPARS):** Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System (CPARS) will likely be applicable but will be determined on a call-by-call basis in accordance with RFO 42.1102 and R-DFARS 242.1102-70 (and CPARS Guide 2016, Section B, 2.0). Interim and final evaluations of contractor performance for contract awards will be prepared in accordance with DAF Contracting Compass Part 42. The final performance evaluation will be prepared at the time of completion of work. In addition to the final evaluation, interim evaluation(s) will be prepared annually. If an IDIQ contract is awarded as a result of a call, CPARS will be conducted for each task order. Awardees will be requested to provide a POC to receive notifications of the opportunity to provide feedback. The contractor will be permitted 14 days to review the document and to submit additional information or a rebutting statement. If agreement cannot be reached between the parties, the matter will be referred to an individual one level above the Contracting Officer, whose decision will be final. Copies of the assessments, contractor responses, and review comments, if any, will be retained as part of the contract file, and may be used to support future award decisions for other procurements.

- h. **Science and Technology (S&T) Protection:** See Attachment: Security Risk Review – AFRLI 61-113. However, the Government may require the offeror to submit additional information and/or a mitigation plan for any identified S&T protection risks. If the Government determines the offeror failed to provide adequate additional information; or an acceptable mitigation plan; or it is determined the offeror's S&T protection approach is high risk & does not provide adequate protection of S&T information, the Government may reject the proposal & withdraw it from consideration for award.
- i. **Overseas Performance:** Overseas performance is not anticipated.
- j. **Unique/Special Clauses:** TBD per individual call/award.
- k. **Organizational Conflict of Interest (OCI):** TBD per individual call/award.
- l. **Associate Contractor Agreement (ACA):** TBD per individual call/award.
- m. **Options:** TBD per individual call/award.

6. **Other Information:**

- a. **Government Furnished Property (GFP) Availability:** TBD per individual call. In accordance with RFO 45.201(b), the contractor is responsible for all costs related to making the property available for use, such as payment of all transportation, installation or rehabilitation costs.
- b. **Government Furnished Information (GFI)/Software:** TBD per individual call/award.
- c. **Base Support/Network Access:** Base Support/Network Access is anticipated and will be determined per individual call.
- d. **Data Rights:** Data Rights will be determined per individual call. Data Rights desired by the contractor should be included with proposal submission as part of the Section K (Reps and Certs) attached to each individual call.

The Air Force Research Laboratory is engaged in the discovery, development, and integration of warfighting technologies for our air, space, and cyberspace forces. As such, rights in noncommercial technical data and noncommercial computer software (NCS) developed or delivered under this contract are of significant concern to the Government. The Government will, therefore, carefully consider any restrictions on the use of noncommercial technical data, NCS, and NCS documentation which could result in transition difficulty or less-than full and open competition for subsequent development of this technology. In accordance with R-DFARS 252.227-7989 (DEVIATION 2026-O0036), the Government shall receive unlimited rights in all noncommercial technical data, noncommercial computer software, and noncommercial computer software documentation developed exclusively with Government funds. In accordance with R-DFARS 252.227-7989 (DEVIATION 2026-O0036), the Government shall receive Government Purpose Rights in all noncommercial technical data, noncommercial computer software, and noncommercial computer software documentation developed with mixed funding. "Developed with mixed funding" means "development was accomplished partially with costs charged to indirect cost pools and/or costs not allocated to a government contract, and partially with costs charged

directly to a government contract. Offerors that propose delivery of noncommercial technical data, NCS, or NCS documentation subject to Government Purpose Rights should fully explain how the data was developed at private expense. Specifically, offerors must explain what noncommercial technical data, NCS, or NCS documentation developed with costs charged to indirect cost pools and/or costs not allocated to a Government contract will be incorporated, how the incorporation will benefit the program, and address whether those portions or processes are segregable.

Offerors that propose delivery of technical data, NCS, or NCS documentation subject to Limited Rights, Restricted Rights, or Specifically Negotiated License Rights will be considered. Proposals shall fully explain what technical data, NCS, or NCS documentation developed with costs charged to indirect cost pools and/or costs not allocated to a Government contract will be incorporated and how the incorporation will benefit the program and whether those portions or processes are segregable.

Offerors shall include the data rights assertions as required by R-DFARS 252.227-7992 (DEVIATION 2026-O0036) Identification and Assertion of Use, Release, or Disclosure Restrictions. The assertions list is included in Section K of the individual call and due at time of proposals. Assertions must be completed with specificity. Each assertion must identify both the data, and each such item, component, or process listed. Nonconforming data rights assertion lists will not be accepted until submitted in accordance with R-DFARS 252.227-7992 (DEVIATION 2026-O0036).

Terms used in this section are defined in the clauses at R-DFARS 252.227-7989 (DEVIATION 2026-O0036), Rights in Technical Data, Computer Software, and Computer Software Documentation – Other Than commercial Products and Commercial Services.

THIRD PARTY SOFTWARE (COMMERCIAL AND NONCOMMERCIAL):

R-DFARS 252.227-7989 (DEVIATION 2026-O0036) describes requirements for incorporation of third party computer software. Any third party software (commercial and noncommercial) to be incorporated into a deliverable must be clearly identified in the proposal. Prior to delivery of any third party software, the contractor will obtain an appropriate license for the Government, and the written approval of the Contracting Officer.

Any third party software to be delivered to the Government that is not reasonably identifiable at proposal submission, must still be approved by the contracting officer prior to incorporation into a system deliverable. This obligation to obtain pre-approval by the contracting officer, as described above, continues throughout contract administration.

In accordance with R-DFARS 227.7202-1, commercial computer software or commercial computer software documentation shall be acquired under the licenses customarily provided to the public unless such licenses are inconsistent with Federal procurement law or do not otherwise satisfy user needs. Therefore, the Government will neither accept nor execute a DD Form 250 for the software deliverables until the Contractor obtains from the Licenser a license that is consistent with Federal procurement law and meets user needs. The following is a non-exhaustive list of terms and conditions that are inconsistent with Federal procurement law and/or do not meet user needs and shall not be included in the commercial computer software license agreement between the licensor and the Government as licensee:

- 1) The license shall not subject the Government to liability that is indefinite or indeterminate, such as an indemnification clause, as it would constitute an obligation in advance or in excess of an appropriation and violate the Anti-Deficiency Act.
- 2) The license shall not create a contingent liability for the Government. This includes, but is not limited to: unilateral price increases, automatic assessment of charges, and automatic renewal of the license.
- 3) The license shall be governed by Federal Statutes, Case Law, and Federal Regulations, and shall not be subject to the laws or jurisdiction of any municipality, state, or foreign country.
- 4) The license shall not include non-substitution language that would preclude or limit the Government from using another vendor/reseller and/or product to fulfill Government requirements.
- 5) The license shall not comment on entitlement to attorney fees.
- 6) The Licenser shall not have the authority to unilaterally terminate the license. All remedies available shall be consistent with the Disputes Clause in the underlying basic contract.
- 7) The Licenser shall not have the right to enter the premise or monitor the networks of Licensee for the purpose of auditing the use of the license.

- 8) The Licensor shall not use any injunctive relief clauses as the Licensor cannot prevent the Licensee from performing mission operations.
- 9) The Licensor shall not have the authority to control any litigation between a third party and the Licensee. The United States Department of Justice has the sole authority to represent the Government in all litigation before federal courts.
- 10) The Licensor shall not use the fact that the Licensee is using the Licensor's products in any notification to the public (e.g., no publicity rights permitted).
- 11) The license shall not require automatic updates or give the Licensor the authority to unilaterally replace the software.

II. Award Information:

1. **Anticipated Award Date:** TBD per individual call.
2. **Anticipated funding:** TBD per individual call, to include funding profile.

III. Eligibility Information:

1. **Eligible Offeror:** This is an unrestricted solicitation. Businesses/Educational Institutions of all sizes are encouraged to propose on all or any part of this solicitation under each call.
2. **Cost Sharing or Matching:** Cost Sharing is not required.
3. **Federally Funded Research and Development Centers:** The following guidance is provided for Federally Funded Research and Development Centers (FFRDCs) contemplating submitting a proposal, as either a prime or subcontractor. RFO 35.403(b)(4) prohibits an FFRDC from competing with any non-FFRDC concern in response to a Federal agency request for proposal for other than the operation of an FFRDC (with exceptions stated in R-DFARS 235.403(b)(4)). There is no regulation prohibiting an FFRDC from responding to a solicitation. However, the FFRDC's sponsoring agency must first make a determination that the effort being proposed falls within the purpose, mission, general scope of effort, or special competency of the FFRDC, and that determination must be included in the FFRDC's proposal. In addition, AFRL must make a determination that the work proposed would not place the FFRDC in direct competition with domestic private industry. Only after these determinations are made would a determination be made concerning the FFRDC's eligibility to receive an award.
4. **Government Agencies:** If a Government agency is interested in performing work, contact the Technical POC identified in the Call. If those discussions result in a mutual interest to pursue your agency's participation, the effort will be pursued independent of this announcement.

5. **Other:**

- a. **Foreign Participation:** Foreign Participation is not anticipated, however, will be considered on a case-by-case basis and identified in each call. If it is determined that foreign participation is not allowed, the US Prime Contractor and/or Sub-Contractor may hire foreign nationals with prior FDO approval; however, FNs will be limited to Public Domain information only. Public Domain information is defined as information that is releasable to the general public and sometimes referred to as open-source material. Examples include but are not limited to newspapers, magazines and information posted on the internet. Any proprietary information will have to be appropriately protected.
- b. **Export Control:** This acquisition may involve data that is subject to export control laws and regulations. This determination will be made on a case-by-case basis and identified in each call. If the data is determined to be subject to export control laws, only contractors who are registered and certified with the Defense Logistics Services Center (DLSC) and have a legitimate business purpose may participate in this solicitation. Contact the Defense Logistics Services Center, 74 Washington Avenue N., Battle Creek, Michigan 40917-3084 (1-800-352-3572) for further information on the certification process. You must submit a copy of your approved DD Form 2345, Militarily Critical Technical Data Agreement, with your proposal, if applicable.
- c. **Proposal Submissions:** There are no limits on the number of proposals an offeror may submit.

NOTE: You may be ineligible for award if all requirements of this solicitation are not met on the proposal due date as identified in each call.

IV. **Proposal and Submission Information:**

1. **Overview:** Proposals submitted under a call shall be in accordance with the instructions provided both in the specific call and this announcement. For individual calls, the Government intends to review resulting proposals and award all, some, or none of the proposal received without negotiations/discussions. However, the Government does reserve the right to negotiate with those offerors whose proposals have been selected for funding. Offerors should be alert for any ARA/Call amendments that may change proposal requirements or permit extensions to the proposal submission date.
2. **Proposal Instructions:**
 - a. General Instructions:
 - 1) Offerors will submit a technical/management and cost/business proposal no later than due date/time listed within each call. After receipt, proposals will be reviewed in accordance with the award criteria as defined in the Call. Proposals will be categorized and subsequently selected for negotiations.

- 2) Offerors should apply the restrictive notice prescribed in RFO 52.215-1(e) Instructions to Offerors—Competitive Acquisition
- 3) Technical/management and cost/business volumes should be submitted in separate volumes and must be valid for 180 days.
- 4) Proposals must reference the announcement number FA8650-20-S-1119 and relevant technical area(s) of interest.
- 5) Offerors must submit one (1) copy of their proposals to the Contracting POC via email.
- 6) Offeror's entire proposal must be submitted without password protection and must include a) cost file(s) spreadsheet(s) in Microsoft Excel including the formulas for calculating cost element bases (i.e., G&A, O/H, etc.) and b) Technical/Management proposals and Statement of Work provided in Microsoft Word.
- 7) Offerors are advised that only Contracting Officers are legally authorized to contractually bind or otherwise commit the Government.
- 8) The cost of preparing proposals in response to this ARA is not considered an allowable direct charge to any resulting or any other contract; however, it may be an allowable expense to the normal bid and proposal indirect cost as specified in RFO 31.205-18.
- 9) Classified technical proposals/addendums may be authorized per individual call. Submittal information/delivery instructions will be provided within the specific call, if applicable.

b. Technical/Management Proposal Instructions:

- 1) Page Limitations: The following describes proposal page limitations:
 - a) The Technical/Management Proposal shall be limited to (TBD per individual call) pages.
 - b) Technical/Management Proposals and Statements of Work must be provided in Microsoft Word. Signed pages may be submitted in Adobe.
 - c) Font shall be standard 10-point business font Arial.
 - d) Character spacing must be "normal," not condensed in any manner.
 - e) Pages shall be double-spaced (must use standard double-space function in Microsoft Word), 8.5 by 11 inches, with at least one-inch margins on both sides, top and bottom.
 - f) All text, including text in tables and charts, must adhere to all font size and line spacing requirements listed herein. Font and line spacing requirements do not have to be followed for illustrations, flowcharts, drawings, and diagrams. These exceptions shall not be used to circumvent formatting requirements and page count limitations by including lengthy narratives in such items.
 - g) Pages shall be numbered starting with the cover page being Page 1, and the last page being no greater than Page (TBD per individual call). The page limitation covers all information including indices, photographs, foldouts (counted as 1 page for each 8.5 by 11 portion) tables, charts, appendices, attachments, resumes, etc.

- h) The proposal page limit does not include the offeror's proposed Statement of Work (SOW); however, the same formatting rules apply to the SOW, which is limited to (TBD per individual call) pages.
NOTE: The Government will check the proposal and SOW for conformance to the stated requirements. Any pages in excess of the stated page limitation after the format check will not be considered for review purposes.
- 2) The Technical/Management proposal(s) shall include a discussion of the nature and scope of the technical approach. Additional information on prior work in this area, descriptions of available equipment, use of base support (if desired), data and facilities and resumes of personnel who will be participating in this effort should also be included as attachments to the technical proposal. This volume(s) shall include a SOW(s) detailing the technical tasks proposed to be accomplished under the proposed effort and suitable for contract incorporation. ***Do not include any proprietary information in the SOW.*** In addition to the contractor proposed SOW, a Government generated SOW Supplement containing additional contracting requirements will be included in any resulting contracts.
- 3) Any questions concerning the technical proposal or SOW preparation shall be referred to the Technical POC listed in Overview on page 3 of this solicitation.

c. **Cost/Business Proposal Solicited Via Calls:**

- 1) Separate the proposal into a business section and cost section. Adequate price competition is anticipated for each call.
 - a) A Model Contract for FAR-based contracts will be provided as an attachment to individual calls issued under this ARA. No sample is provided for Other Transactions. Note that the Model Contract will provide examples of clauses that may be included in final contracts and will provide a basic contract structure. Contracts that are ultimately awarded against the individual calls may vary based on individual program requirements, negotiated terms and conditions, etc.
 - b) The business section should contain all business aspects to the proposed contract, such as type of contract, any exceptions to terms and conditions of the individual call's Model Contract, any information not technically related, etc. Provide rationale for exceptions to any portion of the individual call's Model Contract.
 - c) Identify any technical data that will be delivered with less than unlimited rights.
 - d) Subcontracting Plans: For efforts to exceed \$900,000, Subcontracting Plans shall be submitted in the cost/business proposal. Reference RFO 19.206-2 for subcontracting plan requirements. Small business concerns are exempt from this requirement.
 - e) Limitations on Pass-Through Charges: As prescribed in RFO 15.110(v)(1) & RFO 15.408(v)(2), provisions RFO 52.215-22, "Limitations on Pass Through Charges- Identification of Subcontract

Effort (Oct 2009),” apply. Justification for exceeding the limits must be provided with the proposal.

- f) Complete the Representations and Certifications (Section K - attached to each individual call) and submit with all proposals.
 - g) If an offeror proposes the use of Government Furnished Property (GFP), other than GFP identified in the call (if applicable), the offer must specifically identify each piece of GFP in the Cost/Business Proposal and propose and substantiate a rental cost for evaluation purposes in accordance with RFO 45.202. Include the following information in the proposal:
 - i. A list describing all Government property that the offeror or its subcontractors propose to use on a rent-free basis. The list shall identify the accountable contract under which the property is held and the authorization for its use (from the contracting officer having cognizance of the property);
 - ii. The dates during which the property will be used and, for any property that will be used concurrently in performing two or more contracts, the amounts of the respective uses in sufficient detail to support prorating the rent;
 - iii. The amount of rent that would otherwise be charged in accordance with RFO 52.245-9, Use and Charges; and
 - iv. The voluntary consensus standard or industry leading practices and standards to be used in the management of Government property, or existing property management plans, methods, practices, or procedures for accounting for property.
- 2) **Cost Element Breakdown:** Clear, concise, and accurate cost proposals reflect the offeror's financial plan for accomplishing the effort contained in the technical proposal. As a part of its cost proposal, the offeror shall submit the information outlined below, together with supporting breakdowns. All direct costs (labor, material, travel, computer, etc.) as well as labor and overhead rates should be provided by contractor fiscal year (CFY) and further summarized for the whole effort. In addition, costs should be broken down and summarized by individual task area. Detailed cost element breakdowns by Government Fiscal Year or calendar year are not required. The supporting schedules may include summary level estimating rationale used to generate the proposed costs. The cost element breakdown(s) should include the following if applicable.
- a) **Direct Labor:** Direct labor should be detailed by number of labor hours by category of labor.
 - b) **Labor and Overhead Rates:** Direct labor hours, with applicable rates, must be broken out with bases clearly identified. The source of labor and overhead rates and all pricing factors should be identified. For instance, if a Forward Pricing Rate Agreement (FPRA) is in existence, that should be noted, along with the Administrative Contracting Officer's (ACO) name and telephone number. If the rates are based on current experience in your organization, provide the historical base used and clearly identify all escalation, by year, applied to derive the proposed

rates. If computer usage is determined by a rate, identify the basis used and rationale used to derive the rate.

- c) **Material/Equipment:** List all material/equipment items by type and kind with associated costs and advise if the costs are based on vendor quotes, data and/or engineering estimates; provide copies of vendor quotes and/or catalog pricing data.
- d) **Subcontractor Costs:** Submit all subcontractor proposals and analyses with your cost proposal (See RFO 15.404-8(a)). If the subcontractor will not submit cost and pricing information to the offeror, this information must be submitted directly to the Government for analysis. On all subcontracts and interdivisional transfers, provide the method of selection used to determine the subcontractor and the proposed contract type of each subcontract. An explanation shall be provided if the offeror proposes a different amount than that quoted by the subcontractor. The offeror's proposal must:
 - i. Identify principal items/services to be subcontracted.
 - ii. Identify prospective subcontractors and the basis on which they were selected. If non-competitive, provide selected source justification.
 - iii. Identify the type of contractual business arrangement contemplated for the subcontract and provide rationale
 - iv. Identify the basis for the subcontract costs (e.g., firm quote or engineering estimate, etc.).
 - v. Identify the cost or pricing data submitted by the subcontractor.
 - vi. Provide thorough analysis of the proposed subcontract(s) in accordance with RFO 15.404-8(b). Analysis should address the reasonableness, realism and completeness of each subcontractor's proposal. If the analysis is based on comparison with historical prices, identify the basis on which the historical prices were determined to be reasonable. The analysis should include, but not be limited to, an analysis of: materials, labor, travel, other direct costs and proposed profit or fee rates.
- e) **Special Tooling or Test Equipment:** When special tooling, and/or test equipment is proposed, attach a brief description of items and indicate if they are solely for the performance of this particular contract or project and if they are or are not already available in the offeror's existing facilities. Indicate quantities, unit prices, whether items are to be purchased or fabricated, whether items are of a severable nature and the basis of the price. These items may be included under Direct Material in the summary format.
- f) **Consultants:** When consultants are proposed to be used in the performance of the contract, indicate the specific project or area in which such services are to be used. Identify each consultant, number of hours or days to be used and the consultant's rate per hour or day. State the basis of said rate and give your analysis of the acceptability of the consultant's rate.
- g) **Travel:** Travel costs must be justified and related to the needs of the project. Identify the number of trips, the destination and purpose.

Travel costs should be broken out by trip with number of travelers, airfare, per diem, lodging, etc. Supporting documentation should be provided.

- h) **Computer Use:** Detail the amount and kind of computer usage, the cost, and how the costs were derived.
- i) **Facilities Capital Cost of Money:** If Facilities Capital Cost of Money is proposed, a properly executed DD Form 1861 is required.
- j) **Project Funding Profile:** Offerors should include a project funding profile by Government Fiscal Year (GFY) (1 Oct through 30 Sept) for budgetary purposes. This will enable the Government to easily identify program funding needs by GFY.
- k) If an offeror takes exceptions to the requirements called out in the announcement (e.g., base support, Government-furnished property (GFP), CDRs), the exceptions should be clearly stated in the cost proposal.
- l) **Forward Pricing Rate Agreements:** Offerors who have forward pricing rate agreements (FPRAs) from DCMA should submit them with their proposal.
- m) Cost/Business proposals have no page limitations.

V. Proposal Review Information:

1. **Proposal - Peer or Scientific Review Criteria:** Proposals will be reviewed through Peer or Scientific Review using the criteria below, unless otherwise indicated in each individual call. The technical aspect, which is ranked as the first order of priority, shall be reviewed based on the following criteria that are of equal order of importance.

a. Technical Merit:

- 1) The offeror's understanding of the scope of the technical effort.
- 2) Soundness of the offeror's technical approach including whether the proposal demonstrates related experience and qualification of technical personnel.
- 3) Proposal's potential to advance technology and the state of the art and to meet mission and agency needs.
- 4) The potential to transition the research and development deliverables to future Government needs. Any proposed restriction on technical data or computer software will be considered.

- b. **Cost/Price:** The cost/price criterion includes the realism of the proposed cost. Cost/Price is a substantial factor but ranked as the second order of priority. (If an offeror proposes the use of GFP other than any GFP identified in the individual call, and that proposed GFP provides the offeror an unfair competitive advantage, then RFO 45.202 requires rental equivalent be applied to the Cost Factor for evaluation purposes only).

2. **Proposal – Review and Selection Process:**

- a. **Categories:** Based on the Peer or Scientific Review, proposals will be categorized as Selectable or Not Selectable (see definitions below). The selection of one or more sources for award will be based on the Peer or Scientific Review, as well as importance to agency programs and funding availability.
 - 1) **Selectable:** Proposals are recommended for acceptance if sufficient funding is available.
 - 2) **Not Selectable:** Even if sufficient funding existed, the proposal should not be funded.
- b. No other criteria will be used.
- c. Prior to award of a potentially successful offer, the Contracting Officer will make a determination regarding price reasonableness.

NOTE: The Government reserves the right to award some, all, or none of proposals. When the Government elects to award only a part of a proposal, the selected part may be categorized as Selectable, though the proposal as a whole may not merit such a categorization.

VI. **Award Administration Information:**

1. **Award Notices:** Offerors will be notified whether the proposal is recommended for award on or about 30 days after receipt of the proposal. The notification is not to be construed to mean the award of a contract is assured, as availability of funds and successful negotiations are prerequisites to any award.
2. **Administrative and National Policy Requirements:** See Section I.
3. **Reporting:** See ARA Paragraph I.4., Contract Data Requirements List (CDRL).

VII. **Other Information:**

1. **Acquisition of Commercial Items:** Based upon market research, the Government is not using the policies contained in Part 12, Acquisition of Commercial Items, in this solicitation. However, interested offerors may identify to the Contracting Officer their interest and capability to satisfy the Government's requirement with a commercial item within 15 days of this notice.
2. **Support Contractors:** Only Government employees will participate in Peer or Scientific Reviews. Offerors are advised that employees of commercial firms under contract to the Government may be used to administratively process proposals, monitor contract performance, or perform other administrative duties requiring access to other contractors' proprietary information. These support contracts include nondisclosure agreements prohibiting their contractor employees from disclosing any information submitted by other contractors or using such information for any purpose other than that for which it was furnished.

3. **Item Unique Identification and Valuation:** It is DoD policy that contractors shall be required to identify the Government's unit acquisition cost for all deliverable end items for which Item Unique Identification applies. Therefore, proposals must clearly break out the unit acquisition cost for any deliverable items. See R-DFARS 211.274-3, Requirements for Valuation, for more information. (Per DoD, "fully burdened unit costs" to the Government would include all direct, indirect, G&A costs, and an appropriate portion of fee). For more information, see the following website:
<http://www.acq.osd.mil/dpap/pdi/uid/index.html>.
4. **Informal Feedback Sessions:** When requested, an informal feedback session will be provided. The process will follow the guidelines outlined in the notification letter.
5. **Associate Contractor Agreements:** Associate Contractor Agreements (ACAs) are agreements between contractors working on Government contracts that specify requirements for them to share information, data, technical knowledge, expertise, or resources. The Contracting Officer may require ACAs when contractors working on separate Government contracts must cooperate, share resources or otherwise jointly participate in working on contracts or projects. Prime contractor to subcontractor relationships do not constitute ACAs. For each award, the Contracting Officer will identify associate contractors with whom agreements are required.
6. **Updates of Publicly Available Information Regarding Responsibility Matters:** Any contract award that exceeds \$750,000; and when offeror checked "has" in paragraph (b) of the provision RFO 52.209-7, shall contain the clause, RFO 52.209-9, "Updates of Publicly Available Information Regarding Responsibility Matters (JUL 2013)."
7. **Proposal Content Checklist:** You may be ineligible for award if all requirements of this solicitation are not met on the proposal due date.
 - a. Proposals are due to the Contracting POC.
 - b. Proposals are due no later than the due date and time specified in the Call.
 - c. Proposal page limits are strictly enforced. See Section IV.2.b.1 of the solicitation for page limits.
 - d. If a contract is proposed, completed Certifications and Representations (Section K) are required. See Section K, attached to each individual call.
 - e. The Cost/Business Proposal must contain all information described in the Content and Form of Proposal Section.
 - f. For any subcontracts proposed, the Cost/Business Proposal must contain a subcontractor analysis IAW RFO 15.404-8(b).
 - g. Offerors other than small businesses are to include a subcontracting plan in Microsoft Word Readable Format.
 - h. Proposals must be submitted in the format specified in Section IV.
 - i. Offerors who have Forward Pricing Rate Agreements (FPRA's) should submit them with their proposal.
 - j. If a DD254 is applicable, offerors must verify their Cognizant Security Office information is current with Defense Security Service (DSS) at www.dss.mil.

- k. If the effort is subject to Export Control, offerors must submit a Certified DD Form 2345, Militarily Critical Technical Data Agreement, with proposal.

ATTACHMENTS:

Security Risk Review – AFRLI 61-113

Appendix 1, Security Program Questionnaire

Appendix 2, Research and Related Senior and Key Person Profile Worksheet

Appendix 3, "Privacy Act Statement" consent form for each Covered Individual that is also signed by the Applicant/Recipient as that Individual's Sponsor